

MARKETING MANAGEMENT

Course Code: IM345AT | Semester IV | L:T:P 3:0:0 | 45 Hours

UNIT III

Web Analytics, Google Analytics & E-mail Marketing

Unit III is the measurement unit. The first half covers web analytics and Google Analytics — what to measure, which tools to use, and how to turn website data into decisions. The second half covers e-mail marketing end to end: the opt-in list, the nine content types, the seven-node plan, the measurement funnel and offline tracking.

TOPICS COVERED IN THIS UNIT

Web Analytics & Google Analytics: Google Analytics Tools; Web Analytics Tools.

E-mail Marketing: Effective E-mail Campaigns; E-mail Plan; E-mail Marketing Campaign Analysis; Measuring Conversions & keeping up.

ABOUT THESE NOTES

These notes are **unofficial**. They have been documented by students from **Vikram Sir's handwritten notes, lecture slides and classroom sessions**, and restructured to follow the official IM345AT syllabus unit by unit. Where the source notes were incomplete, the gaps have been filled from standard marketing-management texts and clearly integrated into the same flow. Every previous-year question in the question bank at the end has been extracted verbatim from the actual RVCE CIE and SEE papers for this course. This document is a study aid and is not issued, endorsed or verified by the Department of Industrial Engineering and Management or by RV College of Engineering. Always cross-check against the official syllabus and your own class notes.



Semester: IV						
MARKETING MANAGEMENT						
Category: Professional Core Course (Theory)						
Course Code	:	IM345AT		CIE Marks	:	100 Marks
Credits: L:T:P	:	3:0:0		SEE Marks	:	100 Marks
Total Hours	:	45L		SEE Duration	:	3.00 Hours
UNIT-I						07Hrs
Introduction to Digital Marketing: Principles of Digital Marketing; Digital Marketing Channels; Tools to Create Buyer Persona; Competitor Research Tools, Website Analysis Tools, etc. Content Marketing: Content Marketing Concepts & Strategies; Planning, Creating, Distributing & Promoting Content; Optimize Website UX & Landing Pages; Measure Impact; Metrics & Performance; Using Content Research for Opportunities, etc.						
UNIT-II						08Hrs
Social Media Marketing: Introduction; Major Social Media Platforms for Marketing; Developing Data-driven Audience & Campaign Insights; Social Media for Business; Creation & Optimization of Social Media Campaigns, etc. Search Engine Optimization: Search Engine Optimization Fundamentals; Keywords and SEO Content Plan; SEO & Business Objectives; Writing SEO Content; On-site & off-site SEO; Optimize Organic Search Ranking, etc.						
UNIT-III						07Hrs
Web Analytics & Google Analytics: Google Analytics Tools; Web Analytics Tools, etc. E-mail Marketing: Effective E-mail Campaigns; E-mail Plan; E-mail Marketing Campaign Analysis; Measuring Conversions & keeping up, etc.						
UNIT-IV						07Hrs
Web Design: Web design, optimization of websites; Publishing a basic website; User-centered Design and Website Optimization; Design Principles and Website Copy; Website Metrics & Developing Insight, etc. Mobile Marketing: Difference between mobile advertising and marketing, utilizing mobile marketing for sales promotions, online applications, etc.						
UNIT-V						07Hrs
Conversion Optimization: What is AIDAS and its role; website optimization; what visitors want to see on the website; how to optimize key element and increase the effect of landing on a particular page Digital Analytics: Evolution of Digital Analytics, information about end-to-end customer experience, analyst's influence on business, role as a change agent, etc.						

Course Outcomes: After completing the course, the students will be able to	
CO1	Differentiate the benefits drawn by updated marketing mix from traditional marketing mix for effective marketing management there by to stay competitive in today's global market-place.
CO2	Develop an effective holistic marketing atmosphere to efficiently face the challenges in dynamically changing market.
CO3	Formulate a potential marketing plan to effectively reach the targeted market segments, by delivering the value to targeted customers through practicing sound marketing research.
CO4	Create new channels to improvise marketing to achieve and maintain competitive position in globalized market-place.

Reference Books	
1.	Marketing Management, Philip Kotler, Kevin Lane Keller, 15 th Edition, 2016, Pearson, ISBN:978-93-325-5718-5
2.	Digital Marketing - Strategy, Implementation & Practice, Dave Chaffey, Fiona Ellis – Chadwick, 7 th Edition, 2019, Pearson, ISBN - 9781292241623, 1292241624
3.	Marketing Research, Donald S Tull, Del I Hawkins, 6 th Edition, Prentice Hall India, ISBN: 8120309618
4.	Marketing Management - A South Asian Perspective, Philip Kotler, Kevin Lane Keller, Abraham Koshy, MithileshwarJha, 14 th Edition, 2013, Pearson, ISBN –978-81-317-6716-0
5.	Marketing Research, David A. Aaker, V. Kumar, George S. Day, 9 th Edition, 2008, John Wiley & Sons, ISBN: 978-265-1791-6



RUBRIC FOR THE CONTINUOUS INTERNAL EVALUATION (THEORY)		
#	COMPONENTS	MARKS
1.	QUIZZES: Quizzes will be conducted in online/offline mode. TWO QUIZZES will be conducted & Each Quiz will be evaluated for 10 Marks. THE SUM OF TWO QUIZZES WILL BE THE FINAL QUIZ MARKS.	20
2.	TESTS: Students will be evaluated in test, descriptive questions with different complexity levels (Revised Bloom's Taxonomy Levels: Remembering, Understanding, Applying, Analyzing, Evaluating, and Creating). TWO tests will be conducted. Each test will be evaluated for 50 Marks, adding upto 100 Marks. FINAL TEST MARKS WILL BE REDUCED TO 40 MARKS.	40
3.	EXPERIENTIAL LEARNING: Students will be evaluated for their creativity and practical implementation of the problem. Case study-based teaching learning (10), Program specific requirements (10), Video based seminar/presentation/demonstration (20) ADDING UPTO 40	40
MAXIMUM MARKS FOR THE CIE THEORY		100

RUBRIC FOR SEMESTER END EXAMINATION (THEORY)		
Q. NO.	CONTENTS	MARKS
PART A		
1	Objective type questions covering entire syllabus	20
PART B (Maximum of TWO Sub-divisions only)		
2	Unit 1: (Compulsory)	16
3 & 4	Unit 2: (Internal Choice)	16
5 & 6	Unit 3: (Internal Choice)	16
7 & 8	Unit 4: (Internal Choice)	16
9 & 10	Unit 5: (Internal Choice)	16
TOTAL		100

3.1 Web Analytics — Fundamentals

3.1.1 Definition and Importance

DEFINITION — CIE-II, 26 May 2026 (2 marks)

Web Analytics is the process of collecting, measuring, analysing and reporting website data in order to understand and optimise web usage.

Importance in digital marketing: it helps understand customer behaviour; measures campaign effectiveness; improves website performance; and supports better marketing decisions.

Web analytics converts anonymous traffic into evidence. Without it, digital marketing loses the one structural advantage it holds over traditional marketing — measurability.

3.1.2 Traditional Marketing Analysis vs Web Analytics-Based Analysis

Asked as a 10-mark question in CIE-II of May 2026.

Aspect	Traditional Marketing Analysis	Web Analytics-Based Marketing Analysis
Data collection	Surveys and interviews	Real-time online tracking
Speed	Slow	Instant
Accuracy	Limited — relies on recall and self-reporting	Highly accurate — records actual behaviour
Customer tracking	Difficult	Easy
Cost	Expensive	Cost-effective
Measurement	Estimated results	Measurable KPIs
Sample	A sample of respondents	The entire population of visitors
Attribution	Largely guesswork	Channel and campaign level attribution
Feedback loop	Post-campaign	Continuous, mid-campaign
Example	A focus group is asked whether an advertisement was memorable	Google Analytics shows exactly how many people saw the ad, clicked, browsed and purchased

3.1.3 The Three Metric Families

Family	Question it answers	Metrics
VOLUME	<i>Are we being seen?</i> (Attract)	Impressions — the number of times content is seen. Visits/Sessions — total times people have been to the site. Reach — total users receiving brand content
QUALITY	<i>Are we relevant?</i> (Engage)	Bounce rate — people arriving and leaving without visiting another page. Session duration — time spent per visit. Sentiment — positive, negative or neutral brand mentions
ACTION	<i>Are they engaging?</i> (Measure)	Click-Through Rate (CTR) — percentage of people who see content and click. Conversion rate — percentage who buy versus who arrived. Engagement rate — ratio of people taking action to total who saw the content

3.1.4 Core Web Analytics Metrics — Definitions

Users / Unique visitors — the number of distinct individuals who visited the site in a period, de-duplicated by client identifier.

Sessions / Visits — a group of interactions by one user within a given time frame; a single user may generate many sessions.

Pageviews — the total number of pages loaded; **unique pageviews** counts a page once per session.

Bounce rate — the percentage of visitors who leave a website after viewing only one page without any interaction. A high bounce rate usually signals poor message match, slow loading, weak content or the wrong traffic.

Exit rate — the percentage of sessions that *ended* on a given page. Different from bounce rate — an exit is not necessarily a failure (an order-confirmation page should have a high exit rate).

Average session duration — the mean time users spend per session; a proxy for content depth and interest.

Pages per session — the average number of pages viewed per session; a measure of site exploration.

Conversion rate — the percentage of sessions or users completing a defined goal — purchase, sign-up, download, enquiry.

Goal / Conversion — a specific, valuable, trackable user action that the site is designed to produce.

Acquisition channel — the grouping that describes where a session came from — organic search, paid search, direct, referral, social, e-mail, display.

New vs returning visitors — the split between first-time and repeat users; a retention signal.

Dimensions and Metrics — (SEE Oct/Nov 2023, 2 marks) **Dimensions** are the *attributes* of the data — the qualitative descriptors that answer “what” or “where” (city, device, browser, source/medium, page path, landing page). **Metrics** are the *quantitative measurements* — the numbers (sessions, users, pageviews, bounce rate, revenue). In a report, dimensions form the rows and metrics form the columns.

3.1.5 Bounce Rate and Website Performance Assessment

EXAM ANSWER — CIE-II 26 May 2026 and SEE Jun/Jul 2025 (2 marks)

Bounce rate is the percentage of visitors who leave a website after viewing only one page without any interaction.

Effect on performance evaluation: a high bounce rate indicates that visitors are not finding what they expected — signalling poor content relevance, slow page load, confusing design, weak calls to action or mismatched traffic. It therefore acts as an early diagnostic of both content quality and traffic quality, and correlates with lower conversion rates. It must always be read in context, however: a blog answering a question fully, or a contact page giving a phone number, may legitimately show a high bounce.

3.1.6 The Dual Lens — Web vs Social Analytics

	The Website Footprint	The Social Echo
Focus	On-site behaviour and technical specifications	Off-site popularity and brand conversation
Key data	Device type, make and model; browser, resolution, operating system; language and location; new vs returning visitors; traffic sources; funnel conversion from start to end of purchase	Mentions; followers; buzz (a combined popularity measure); share of voice (conversations about you versus the competition); sentiment

	The Website Footprint	The Social Echo
Major players	Google Analytics, Adobe Analytics, Webtrends	Facebook Insights, Twitter/X Analytics, Hootsuite

3.2 Google Analytics

3.2.1 Purpose

EXAM ANSWER — CIE-II 07.05.2025 (2 marks)

The main purpose of Google Analytics is to **collect, measure and report data about website and app users** — who they are, how they arrived, what they did and whether they converted — so that businesses can understand user behaviour, evaluate marketing performance and make evidence-based decisions to improve traffic quality and conversions.

3.2.2 Key Features of Google Analytics

EXAM ANSWER — CIE-II, 26 May 2026 (2 marks)

Four important features for website performance tracking: **(1) traffic source analysis, (2) bounce rate measurement, (3) user demographics tracking, (4) conversion and goal tracking.**

A fuller list, useful for 8- and 10-mark answers:

- **Real-time reporting** — who is on the site right now, and what they are doing.
- **Audience reports** — demographics, interests, geography, language, technology and device.
- **Acquisition reports** — which channels, sources, mediums and campaigns delivered the traffic.
- **Behaviour / Engagement reports** — landing pages, exit pages, site content performance, site search, page load times.
- **Conversion and goal tracking** — destination, duration, pages-per-session and event goals; assigning monetary value to conversions.
- **E-commerce tracking** — product performance, shopping and checkout behaviour, average order value, revenue.
- **Funnel visualisation** — where users drop out of a defined multi-step path.
- **Segments** — isolating a subset of users (e.g. mobile users from paid search who did not convert).
- **Attribution and Model Comparison** — how credit for a conversion is distributed across touchpoints.
- **Custom dashboards, reports and alerts.**
- **Audience building and remarketing lists** exported to Google Ads.
- **Integrations** — Google Ads, Search Console, BigQuery, Google Tag Manager, Looker Studio.

3.2.3 Acquisition Channels

SEE Oct/Nov 2023 asked (Q5a, 8 marks): “Discuss the concept of ‘Acquisition channels’ in Google Analytics. How can business use this information to optimize their marketing efforts.”

Channel	What it means	Typical optimisation action
Organic Search	Unpaid clicks from search engines	Invest in SEO for the pages and queries already converting
Paid Search	Clicks from search ads	Shift budget to keywords with the lowest cost per conversion
Direct	Users typing the URL or using bookmarks (also the catch-all for untagged traffic)	Build brand; audit for missing UTM tags inflating this bucket

Channel	What it means	Typical optimisation action
Referral	Links from other websites	Nurture the partnerships and publications actually sending buyers
Organic Social	Unpaid social posts	Double down on the platform delivering engaged traffic
Paid Social	Social advertising	Reallocate spend by cost per result
Email	Clicks from e-mail campaigns	Increase send frequency to the highest-converting segments
Display	Banner and remarketing ads	Refine placements and exclude low-quality inventory
Affiliates	Partner-driven traffic	Adjust commission by partner quality

How the business uses this: it identifies which channels deliver not just volume but *converting* volume; it exposes the cost per acquisition of each channel so budget can be reallocated; it reveals assisted conversions where a channel contributes without taking the last click; it enables channel-specific landing page optimisation; and it prevents the classic error of judging a channel by traffic when it should be judged by revenue.

3.2.4 Reports Generated Using Google Analytics

SEE Oct/Nov 2023 asked (Q6b, 8 marks): “List and explain the various reports that can be generated using google analytics.”

Report family	What it tells you
Real-Time	Active users right now, their pages, sources and locations — used to verify a campaign launch or tag deployment
Audience / User	Who the visitors are: demographics, interests, geography, language, technology, devices, new vs returning, user lifetime value, cohort retention
Acquisition / Traffic Acquisition	Where users came from — channel, source/medium, campaign, Google Ads and Search Console integration
Behaviour / Engagement	What users did on the site — pages and screens, landing pages, exit pages, site search, page timings, events
Conversions / Monetisation	Goal completions, goal value, funnel visualisation, e-commerce revenue, product performance, checkout behaviour, purchase journey
Attribution / Advertising	How conversion credit is distributed across touchpoints; model comparison
Custom reports & Explorations	User-defined combinations of dimensions and metrics, funnel explorations, path explorations, segment overlap

3.2.5 Setting Up and Tracking Goals

SEE Oct/Nov 2023 asked (Q10b, 6 marks): “Describe the process of setting up and tracking goals in google analytics.”

1. **Define what a conversion means** for the business — a purchase, a form submission, a newsletter sign-up, a brochure download, a call click.
2. **Choose the goal type** — *destination* (a thank-you URL is reached), *duration* (session exceeds a set time), *pages/screens per session*, or *event* (a specific interaction such as a video play or button click). In

GA4 these are configured as **events marked as conversions**.

3. **Implement the tracking** — deploy the tag via **Google Tag Manager**, define the trigger, and fire the event on the qualifying action.
4. **Assign a monetary value** to the goal where possible, so non-transactional conversions can still be compared and optimised.
5. **Configure the funnel** — define the required steps preceding the goal so drop-off is visible step by step.
6. **Verify** using real-time reports and debug mode before relying on the data.
7. **Track and report** — monitor conversion rate by channel, campaign, device and landing page.
8. **Act on the findings** — fix the step with the largest drop-off, reallocate budget to the highest-converting channels, and A/B test the weakest page.

Why goal tracking matters: without it, analytics measures activity rather than outcome. Goals are what convert traffic reports into ROI reports.

3.2.6 Web Analytics Tools Other Than Google Analytics

EXAM ANSWER — CIE-II 07.05.2025 (2 marks)

"Name any two popular web analytics tools other than Google Analytics." — **Adobe Analytics** and **Matomo** (also acceptable: Webtrends, Mixpanel, Hotjar, Microsoft Clarity, Kissmetrics, Piwik PRO, Heap, Amplitude, Crazy Egg, SimilarWeb).

Tool	Strength
Adobe Analytics	Enterprise-grade segmentation, attribution and integration with the Adobe Experience Cloud
Matomo (formerly Piwik)	Open-source and self-hostable; full data ownership and privacy compliance
Webtrends	Long-established enterprise web analytics platform
Mixpanel / Amplitude	Product analytics — event-based funnels, cohorts and retention for apps and SaaS
Hotjar / Microsoft Clarity / Crazy Egg	Qualitative behaviour — heatmaps, scroll maps, click maps and session recordings
Kissmetrics	Person-level tracking across sessions and devices
SimilarWeb	Competitive traffic estimation and benchmarking
Google Search Console	Search-side data — impressions, clicks, average position, indexing and Core Web Vitals
Google Tag Manager	Central deployment and version control of all tracking tags without editing site code
Looker Studio	Dashboarding and reporting across multiple data sources

GOOGLE TAG MANAGER — SEE Jun/Jul 2025, Q6b (8 marks)

“Critically evaluate the contribution of Google Tag Manager in optimizing marketing channels for global companies.”

Contribution: GTM is a container that lets marketers deploy, edit and version tracking tags without a developer, which collapses the change cycle from weeks to minutes; it standardises the data layer across dozens of regional sites so that global reporting is comparable; it centralises consent management, which is essential under GDPR and similar regimes; it reduces page weight by loading tags asynchronously; it enables rapid A/B and campaign experimentation; and it provides preview and version rollback, reducing the risk of breaking measurement.

Critical view: it can become a governance problem — untracked tag sprawl, duplicate conversion firing, degraded page performance and security exposure if publish rights are too widely granted. It also does not fix a poor measurement plan; it only makes deploying one faster.

3.3 The Role of Web Analytics in Digital Marketing

CIE-II of 07.05.2025 asked: “*Explain the role of web analytics in digital marketing. How can businesses benefit from analysing website data?*”

3.3.1 The Role

1. **Measurement of effectiveness** — establishes which campaigns, channels and creatives actually produce results.
2. **Understanding customer behaviour** — reveals the real path users take, not the path the business assumed.
3. **Conversion optimisation** — locates the exact step at which prospects abandon.
4. **Budget allocation** — directs spend to the lowest cost per acquisition.
5. **Content strategy** — identifies which topics and formats attract and hold the audience.
6. **Technical improvement** — surfaces slow pages, broken journeys and device-specific failures.
7. **Segmentation and personalisation** — enables different treatment of different audiences.
8. **Forecasting and target-setting** — historical data makes goals realistic and progress measurable.

3.3.2 Benefits of Analysing Website Data

- Higher conversion rates from evidence-based fixes rather than opinion.
- Lower customer acquisition cost through better channel allocation.
- Improved user experience and reduced bounce.
- Faster detection of problems — a tracking break, a broken checkout, a traffic collapse.
- Better content decisions and less wasted production effort.
- Demonstrable ROI, which protects and justifies marketing budget.
- Competitive advantage from acting on data faster than rivals.

3.3.3 Aligning Web Analytics KPIs with Organisational Goals

A 10-mark CIE-I 2026 question. The five-step method:

1. **Identify business goals** — increase sales, brand awareness, lead generation.
2. **Map goals to relevant KPIs** — *Sales growth* → conversion rate, revenue, cart abandonment rate. *Brand awareness* → website traffic, impressions, reach. *Lead generation* → form submissions, sign-ups. *Customer engagement* → bounce rate, session duration, pages per visit.
3. **Use SMART KPIs** — Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, Time-bound. Example: *increase conversion rate by 10% in 3 months*.
4. **Use analytics tools** — track the KPIs through Google Analytics and dashboards.
5. **Monitor and optimise continuously** — analyse data regularly and modify strategies based on performance.

3.3.4 A/B Testing and Conversion Rate Optimisation

SEE Oct/Nov 2023 asked (Q5b, 8 marks): “*Explain the significance of A/B testing and conversion rate optimization in Web Analytics.*”

A/B testing (split testing) — showing two versions of a page or element to two randomly assigned halves of the traffic simultaneously, and measuring which produces a statistically significantly better outcome on a defined goal.

Conversion Rate Optimization (CRO) — the systematic process of increasing the percentage of visitors who complete a desired action, using analytics, user research and controlled experiments.

- **Significance:** it replaces opinion and seniority with evidence; isolates the effect of a single variable; produces compounding gains, since a 10% lift applies to all future traffic at zero additional acquisition cost; reduces the risk of large redesigns by testing incrementally; and reveals genuine user preference, which frequently contradicts internal assumption.
- **What to test:** headlines, calls-to-action (text, colour, position), hero images, form length and field order, page layout, pricing presentation, trust signals, and check-out flow.
- **Process:** analyse data to find the weakest step → form a hypothesis (“shortening the form from 9 fields to 4 will raise submissions”) → build the variant → split traffic → run to statistical significance → implement the winner → repeat.
- **Tools:** Google Optimize (retired, succeeded by third-party tools), VWO, Optimizely, AB Tasty, plus Hotjar and Microsoft Clarity for the qualitative diagnosis that generates hypotheses.

3.4 E-mail Marketing — Fundamentals

3.4.1 What E-mail Marketing Is

DEFINITION

E-mail marketing is the use of e-mail to deliver commercial and relationship-building messages to a permission-based list of subscribers, in order to acquire, engage, convert and retain customers. It is a vital tool used throughout the **entire sales funnel** — engaging prospects, maintaining interest and driving key revenue for online retailers at a fraction of the cost of direct mail.

3.4.2 E-mail 1.0 vs E-mail 2.0

E-mail 1.0	E-mail 2.0
Simple one-way messages	Behaviour-based triggers
Static auto-responders	Segmented targeting based on purchase history and interests
Mass “batch and blast” distribution	Dynamic lifecycle automation
Untracked engagement	Deep tracking metrics

3.4.3 Advantages of E-mail Marketing

- **Cost and speed** — cheaper and faster than traditional direct mail.
- **Tracking** — real-time visibility into opens, clicks and conversions.
- **Personalization** — dynamic tailoring based on collected data.
- **Global reach** at no incremental cost per recipient.
- **Ownership of the channel** — unlike social media, the list is an owned asset that no algorithm can throttle.
- **Highest conversion and retention rate** of any digital channel.
- **Direct and permission-based** — the recipient asked to hear from you.

FOUR ADVANTAGES OVER TRADITIONAL METHODS — CIE-II 26 May 2026 (2 marks)

Low cost; global reach; easy performance tracking; personalised communication.

3.4.4 Disadvantages and Liabilities

- **Spam and legal risk** — filters block messages, and the CAN-SPAM Act carries severe penalties.
- **Engagement decay** — constant tweaking is required to prevent list fatigue.
- **Code rendering** — appearance breaks across varying e-mail clients, servers and settings (for example, when images are blocked by default).
- **Hidden costs** — scaling campaigns requires design, management and software investment, potentially upward of \$1,000 per month.
- **Deliverability management** — sender reputation, authentication (SPF, DKIM, DMARC) and list hygiene require ongoing attention.
- **Inbox competition** — the average inbox is crowded, so open rates are structurally limited.

3.5 Opt-In vs Spam

THE LEGAL POINT

The **CAN-SPAM Act** levies fines of up to **\$16,000 per violation** for non-compliance. Permission is not a courtesy; it is a legal requirement. Indian and EU equivalents (the IT Act rules and GDPR) impose comparable obligations.

	Spam	Opt-In
Acquisition method	Unsolicited; default web checkboxes; purchased lists	Willingly provided via lead forms in exchange for incentives
Expectation setting	Blind blasting; unpredictable frequency	Clear promises about e-mail type (sales vs tips) and frequency
Brand impact	Degrades reputation; perceived as a nuisance	Builds long-term trust; establishes authority; boosts upsells
List quality	High volume, low intent	Micro-focused, highly targeted engagement

Single opt-in adds the address immediately on submission. **Double opt-in** requires the subscriber to confirm through a verification e-mail — it produces a smaller but far cleaner and more engaged list, improves deliverability and provides documentary proof of consent.

Why segmentation matters in e-mail (SEE Jun/Jul 2025, 2 marks): segmentation divides the list by demographics, purchase history, behaviour, engagement level or lifecycle stage so that each group receives relevant content. It raises open and click rates, reduces unsubscribes and spam complaints, improves deliverability by maintaining engagement, and enables personalisation — which is the single largest driver of e-mail conversion.

3.6 Anatomy of an Effective E-mail

3.6.1 The Three Rules

1. **One topic.** Restrict the e-mail to a single marketing message. Multiple messages create a “busy” user experience; focus drives higher revenue per message.
2. **Attractive, simple design.** The design must complement the message, not distract from it. Design on the assumption that mobile clients may disable images.
3. **Clear call to action.** The reader must never wonder what to do next; the path to purchase must be frictionless.

THE RESULT OF EXPERIENCE

Continuously **A/B test** designs and offers in order to learn customer behaviour. No template is permanently correct.

3.6.2 Checklist for an Effective Marketing E-mail

- A **subject line** that is specific, benefit-led and under about 50 characters — this alone determines the open rate.
- A **recognisable, consistent sender name** — people open based on who sent it as much as what it says.

- **Preheader text** that extends the subject line rather than repeating it.
- **Personalisation** beyond the first name — reference actual behaviour or past purchases.
- **Above-the-fold value** — the offer must be visible without scrolling.
- A **single, prominent, repeated CTA button** with active verb text.
- **Responsive, mobile-first design** — the majority of opens are on mobile.
- **Alt text on every image**, so the message survives image blocking.
- **Plain-text fallback** version.
- A **visible unsubscribe link** and the sender's physical address — both legally required.
- **Tested rendering** across major clients before sending (Litmus tests across ~40 clients in one click).

3.7 The Content Arsenal — Nine Types of Marketing E-mail

The nine templates fall into three strategic groups. Naming the group *and* the rules for each type is what separates a full-mark answer from a list.

3.7.1 Group 1 — Drive Revenue

Type	Goal	Rules
Promotional	Entice immediate purchase	Keep it short; make the offer front-and-centre; create a sense of urgency with active language
New Inventory	Alert customers to new arrivals	Send immediately upon arrival; prioritise a killer product photo; minimise text; tease the reveal in the subject line
Reorder	Replenish consumables (e.g. toner, vitamins)	Make the buying process simple with a 'Reorder Now' button; remind them of the value and the hassle avoided; explicitly mention past purchases

3.7.2 Group 2 — Build Relationships

Type	Goal	Rules
Newsletter	Improve brand awareness	Think "mini-newspaper"; break copy into digestible sections; use simple layouts; always include contact information
Welcome	Establish a relationship with new opt-ins	Use a warm, conversational tone — a "virtual handshake"; offer a reward (e.g. 10% off); remind them of the benefits of joining
Educational	Build trust through industry knowledge	Offer relevant, bite-sized information linking out to full blog posts; include a subtle mini-promotion
Product Advice	Establish authority	Solve customer problems; teach product features; emphasise customer service; proofread meticulously to protect credibility

3.7.3 Group 3 — Gather Intelligence

Type	Goal	Rules
Testimonials	Reinforce business value through social proof	Use a sleek design to frame quotes; pair text with powerful images (customer photos or product shots); offer a link for readers to leave their own feedback
Surveys	Collect data to improve customer experience	Clearly explain the incentive (e.g. a cash prize drawing); explicitly address why the data is being collected; provide a highly visible, clickable access button

3.7.4 Transactional vs Promotional E-mails

SEE Oct/Nov 2023 asked (Q6a, 8 marks): *"Describe the difference between transactional emails and promotional emails. Provide examples of each and explain when to use them."*

Basis	Transactional E-mail	Promotional E-mail
Trigger	A specific action or event performed by the individual user	A marketing calendar or campaign decision

Basis	Transactional E-mail	Promotional E-mail
Purpose	To deliver information the user expects and needs	To generate awareness, demand or sales
Consent required	Implied by the transaction itself	Explicit opt-in required
Volume	One-to-one, automated	One-to-many, batched or segmented
Open rate	Very high (often 40–60%+) because it is expected	Much lower (typically 15–25%)
Examples	Order confirmation, shipping and delivery notification, password reset, OTP, invoice/receipt, account creation, appointment reminder, abandoned-cart reminder (borderline)	Sale announcement, newsletter, new-product launch, seasonal offer, webinar invitation, re-engagement campaign
When to use	Immediately after the triggering event — speed and clarity matter more than design	At planned intervals against a content calendar, targeted to segments

A useful practical point: because transactional e-mails are opened far more often, a small, tasteful promotional element (a related-product strip or loyalty reminder) inside them often outperforms an entire promotional campaign — but the transactional content must remain dominant, or the message loses its legal status as transactional.

3.8 The E-mail Marketing Plan — Seven Nodes

This is the standard framework for every “design an e-mail marketing plan for X” question, and there have been several.

Node	Action
1. Choose software	Select a CRM or e-mail service provider based on the capabilities required — a simple database sender versus full behavioural campaign automation
2. Build the list	Start capturing addresses; commit to quality over quantity ; limit sending to a maximum of about two e-mails per month initially
3. Capture forms	Deploy sign-up forms on the website and blog to gather names, e-mail addresses and phone numbers
4. Define goals	Determine the mission — deepen relationships, educate the audience, or drive sales cycles?
5. Set auto-responders	Build a sequence of at least six educational, non-salesy e-mails released automatically to new subscribers
6. Add triggers	Automate new sales cycles based on specific user actions — for example, clicking a particular link or abandoning a cart
7. Monitor metrics	Review reporting monthly to test subject lines and improve CTR — and feed the insight back into Node 1

IT IS A LOOP, NOT A LINE

The seven nodes form an infinity loop. Node 7 feeds back into Node 1: the metrics tell you whether the software, the list, the goals, the sequences and the triggers are right.

3.8.1 Worked Example — E-mail Plan for a New Online Business Targeting College Students

(CIE-II, 26 May 2026, 10 marks — official scheme answer)

Objective: increase awareness, engagement and sales among college students. **Target audience:** college students aged 18–25.

- Build the e-mail list** — collect e-mails through website sign-ups; offer discounts and free resources.
- Create attractive content** — use youthful, creative designs; include offers, contests and product updates.
- Segmentation** — segment users based on interests and purchase behaviour.
- Personalization** — use customer names and personalised recommendations.
- Campaign schedule** — send weekly newsletters and promotional e-mails.
- Mobile optimization** — ensure e-mails are mobile-friendly.
- Performance tracking** — track open rate, CTR, conversion rate and unsubscribe rate.

3.8.2 Segmentation and Personalisation — Step by Step

(CIE-II, 24 July 2024, 10 marks)

- Collect the right data at capture** — ask only for what you will use, then enrich progressively over time.

2. **Choose segmentation criteria** — demographics (age, location, gender); firmographics for B2B (industry, company size, role); behaviour (pages viewed, products browsed, past purchases, cart abandonment); engagement level (active, lapsing, dormant); lifecycle stage (new subscriber, first-time buyer, repeat customer, advocate); and preference (topics and frequency the subscriber selected).
3. **Build the segments** in the ESP as dynamic rules, so membership updates automatically.
4. **Design content per segment** — different subject line, offer, imagery and CTA for each.
5. **Layer personalisation inside the segment** — merge tags for name, dynamic product blocks based on browsing history, location-specific offers, and send-time optimisation.
6. **Automate lifecycle triggers** — welcome series, browse abandonment, cart abandonment, post-purchase, replenishment, win-back.
7. **Test** — A/B test subject lines and offers *within* each segment, since what works for one will not work for another.
8. **Measure per segment** and prune or re-engage the segments that consistently underperform.

Example: a fashion retailer segments by past category purchase. Subscribers who bought running shoes receive a new-arrivals e-mail featuring running gear with the subject line “New for your next 10K”, while subscribers who bought formal wear receive an entirely different creative. The same send, two segments, typically doubles the click-through rate versus a single generic blast.

3.9 E-mail Marketing Campaign Analysis

3.9.1 What Campaign Analysis Means

EXAM ANSWER — CIE-II, 26 May 2026 (2 marks)

Campaign analysis in e-mail marketing refers to evaluating the performance of e-mail campaigns using metrics such as open rate, click-through rate, conversion rate, bounce rate and unsubscribe rate, in order to determine campaign effectiveness and improve future campaigns.

3.9.2 The Measurement Funnel — The Marketing Control Room

The funnel runs from the top of the list to the bottom line. Each stage narrows, and each has its own formula and diagnostic meaning.

Stage	Definition / formula	What it diagnoses
1. Sent E-mails	The starting list volume. Metric: List Growth Rate	Whether the audience asset is growing or decaying
2. Delivery (Non-Bounce Rate)	100% – (Bounced E-mails ÷ Total Sent) . Accounts for invalid addresses or full firewalls	List hygiene and sender reputation
3. Open Rate	Tracked when images render on the server or links are clicked. Calculated from the non-bounce pool	The strength of the subject line, sender name and send timing
4. Click-Through Rate (CTR)	The percentage of opens that clicked a link. Used to track interests and A/B test variations	The relevance of the content and the clarity of the CTA
5. Conversion Rate	The percentage of clicks that completed the ultimate goal — purchasing, filling a form	The quality of the offer and the landing page
6. Revenue Per Message	Total Revenue ÷ Number of Sent E-mails	The single bottom-line measure of the whole programme

DEFINE CTR — CIE-II 26 May 2026 (2 marks)

Click Through Rate (CTR) is the percentage of recipients who click on links in an e-mail compared to the total number of **delivered** e-mails.

*(Note: the lecture material defines CTR against opens, and the CIE scheme defines it against delivered e-mails — the industry distinguishes these as **click-to-open rate** and **click-through rate** respectively. State the formula you are using and either is defensible.)*

3.9.3 Interpreting the KPIs

(CIE-II, 26 May 2026, 10 marks: “Analyse the effectiveness of an E-mail Marketing campaign using KPIs such as open rate, click-through rate, unsubscribe rate, and conversion rate.”)

KPI	What it measures	What a poor reading means	Fix
Open rate	How many users opened the e-mail	Weak subject line, wrong send time, poor sender reputation	Test subject lines; clean the list; authenticate the domain
Click-Through Rate	How many users clicked links in the e-mail	Content not engaging or CTA unclear	Improve the offer; make one CTA dominant; segment better

KPI	What it measures	What a poor reading means	Fix
Unsubscribe rate	Users opting out of e-mails	Content is irrelevant or frequency is too high	Send relevant content; offer a preference centre instead of only “unsubscribe”
Conversion rate	Users completing the desired action such as a purchase	Offer or landing page is failing, not the e-mail	Fix message match on the landing page; reduce form friction
Bounce rate	Undelivered e-mails	Stale or purchased list; server blocks	Remove hard bounces immediately; use double opt-in
Spam complaint rate	Recipients marking the e-mail as junk	Consent is unclear or expectations were not set	Set expectations at sign-up; make unsubscribe obvious

3.9.4 Challenges and Solutions

(CIE-II, 26 May 2026, 10 marks — official scheme answer)

Challenge	Solution
Low open rates	Use attractive subject lines
Spam filtering issues	Avoid spam words and maintain sender reputation
High unsubscribe rates	Send relevant and useful content
Poor e-mail design	Use responsive e-mail templates
Lack of personalisation	Segment the audience and personalise e-mails
Inactive subscribers	Run re-engagement campaigns

Additional challenges worth naming: deliverability and inbox placement; list decay of roughly 20–25% per year; rendering inconsistency across clients; privacy changes such as Apple Mail Privacy Protection that inflate open rates and make them unreliable; and rising regulatory burden.

3.9.5 Two Strategies to Increase Open and Click Rates

(CIE-II Quiz, 24 July 2024, 2 marks — for a fashion brand's summer sale)

- **To increase open rate:** write a specific, urgency-bearing, personalised subject line and A/B test it — e.g. “Priya, your summer edit is 40% off — today only” — and optimise the send time to the segment's historical open window.
- **To increase CTR:** use a single dominant, benefit-led CTA button above the fold, supported by a strong hero product image and segmented product recommendations based on the recipient's browsing history.

3.10 Measuring Conversions and Keeping Up

3.10.1 Bridging the Gap — Offline Tracking

When open rates and CTR are not enough to track overall marketing success, e-mail requires **physical participation mechanisms**.

Mechanism	How it is tracked
In-store purchases	By requesting the customer's e-mail address at the physical Point of Sale and matching it against the campaign list

Mechanism	How it is tracked
Phone calls	By providing dedicated phone numbers exclusive to the e-mail campaign
Event attendance	By issuing special entrance codes that can only be accessed and viewed from within the e-mail itself

Digital equivalents of the same principle: unique promo codes per campaign, UTM-tagged links feeding Google Analytics, and printable or scannable QR coupons that carry a campaign identifier.

3.10.2 Integrating Web Analytics and E-mail Marketing

(CIE-II, 26 May 2026, 10 marks — official scheme answer)

1. **Collect customer data** — use web analytics tools to track user behaviour, page visits and purchase history.
2. **Audience segmentation** — segment users based on interests and browsing behaviour.
3. **Personalized e-mail campaigns** — send customised e-mails with relevant product recommendations.
4. **Track campaign performance** — use open rate, CTR, conversion rate and bounce rate.
5. **Retargeting** — send follow-up e-mails to abandoned-cart users.
6. **Continuous optimization** — analyse campaign data and improve content and timing.

Benefits: better customer engagement; higher conversion rates; improved customer retention; increased sales and revenue.

3.10.3 The E-mail 2.0 Tech Stack

Category	Tools
CRM & all-in-one automation	HubSpot (automated workflows), Infusionsoft (purchase behaviour / task manager), ActiveCampaign (lifecycle automation), Contactually (social/inbox vetting)
Drip campaigns & nurturing	Drip (lightweight workflow builder), ConvertKit (automation rules for bloggers), Emma (personalisation via CRM sync), Campaign Monitor (interactive analytics), Sendloop
Creation & standard sending	MailChimp (abandoned carts, groups), GetResponse (calendar-integrated autoresponders), AWeber (new subscriber catch-up), Reach Mail (five-campaign simultaneous metric comparison)
Specialized utility	Litmus (one-click render testing across 40 clients), BombBomb (video-powered e-mail), Gumroad (digital product updates), Intercom (in-app conversations)
Sales tracking plugins	GetNotify (invisible open tracking), ToutApp (playbooks / CRM sync), Yesware (prescriptive analytics, team tracking), Clearslide (web engagement tracking)

3.10.4 Responsive E-mail Design

SEE June/July 2025 asked (Q6a, 8 marks): “Evaluate the effectiveness of responsive email design in maintaining a competitive edge in digital marketing.”

- **The case for it:** the majority of e-mail opens now occur on mobile; a non-responsive e-mail requiring pinch-and-zoom is typically deleted within seconds. Responsive design therefore protects open-to-click conversion, reduces unsubscribes, improves accessibility, and preserves brand perception. It also improves deliverability indirectly, because engagement signals feed inbox placement algorithms.
- **How it is achieved:** fluid single-column layouts, media queries, scalable images, minimum 14–16px body text, tap targets of at least 44×44 pixels, bulletproof CTA buttons built in HTML rather than as images, and alt text for image-blocked clients.

- **The critical view:** responsiveness is now table stakes rather than a differentiator — every competent competitor has it, so it prevents disadvantage more than it creates advantage. Genuine competitive edge comes from **segmentation, personalisation, behavioural triggers and offer quality**; responsive design is the precondition that allows those to work. It also adds testing overhead across dozens of clients (hence Litmus), and dark-mode rendering remains inconsistent.

3.10.5 Operating the Engine — Four Pillars

Pillar	What it means
Pillar 1 — The Fuel (Opt-In List)	Cultivate micro-focused, permission-based audiences to eliminate the \$16k legal risk and guarantee engagement
Pillar 2 — The Payload (Content Arsenal)	Deploy the exact right template — Promotional to drive revenue, Educational to build trust, Surveys to gather intelligence
Pillar 3 — The Engine (Triggers & Tech)	Use the tech stack to move from static blasts to dynamic, behavioural, life-cycle automation
Pillar 4 — The Dashboard (Metrics)	Obsess over the measurement funnel — from non-bounce delivery down to total offline revenue generation

THE CLOSING IDEA

E-mail marketing is no longer a megaphone. It is a targeted, measurable, high-ROI ecosystem.

3.11 Key Terms — Quick Revision

Term	One-line meaning
Web analytics	Collecting, measuring, analysing and reporting website data to understand and optimise web usage
Dimension / Metric	Attribute of the data (city, device, source) / quantitative measurement (sessions, revenue)
Session	A group of user interactions within a given time frame
Bounce rate	% of visitors who leave after viewing one page without interaction
Exit rate	% of sessions that ended on a given page
Acquisition channel	The grouping describing where a session came from
Goal / Conversion	A defined valuable user action being tracked
Funnel visualisation	A report showing drop-off at each step of a defined path
Segment	An isolated subset of users defined by shared attributes or behaviour
A/B testing	Splitting traffic between two versions to find the statistically better one
CRO	Conversion Rate Optimization — systematically raising the % who convert
Google Tag Manager	A container for deploying and versioning tracking tags without code changes
Buzz / Share of voice	Combined popularity measure / conversations about you vs competitors
Opt-in	Permission willingly given to receive e-mail
Double opt-in	Consent confirmed through a verification e-mail
CAN-SPAM	US anti-spam law; fines up to \$16,000 per violation
Non-Bounce Rate	$100\% - (\text{bounced} \div \text{total sent})$ — the delivery rate
Open rate	% of delivered e-mails opened
CTR	% of recipients (or opens) who clicked a link
Unsubscribe rate	% of recipients who opted out
Revenue per message	$\text{Total revenue} \div \text{number of sent e-mails}$
Auto-responder	An automated sequence released to new subscribers
Trigger	An automated e-mail fired by a specific user action
Drip campaign	A scheduled nurture sequence delivered over time
Transactional e-mail	A user-triggered informational e-mail (receipt, OTP, shipping)
List decay	The natural annual loss of list quality (~20–25% per year)

3.12 Previous Year Questions — Unit III

A. Two-Mark Questions (Part A)

1. Define Web Analytics and mention its importance in digital marketing activities. [CIE-II 26 May 2026]

Web Analytics is the process of collecting, measuring, analysing and reporting website data to understand and optimise web usage. Importance: it helps understand customer behaviour, measures campaign effectiveness, improves website performance and supports better marketing decisions.

2. What is Bounce Rate in Web Analytics and how does it affect website performance evaluation? [CIE-II 26 May 2026] / How bounce rate affects website performance assessment. [SEE Jun/Jul 2025]

Bounce rate is the percentage of visitors who leave a website after viewing only one page without any interaction. A high bounce rate signals poor content relevance, slow loading, confusing design or mismatched traffic, and correlates with lower conversions — so it acts as an early diagnostic of both content quality and traffic quality.

3. List any four important features available in Google Analytics for website performance tracking. [CIE-II 26 May 2026]

Traffic source analysis; bounce rate measurement; user demographics tracking; conversion and goal tracking.

4. What is the main purpose of using Google Analytics? [CIE-II 07.05.2025]

To collect, measure and report data about website users — who they are, how they arrived, what they did and whether they converted — so businesses can understand behaviour, evaluate marketing performance and make evidence-based decisions.

5. Name any two popular web analytics tools other than Google Analytics. [CIE-II 07.05.2025]

Adobe Analytics and Matomo. (Also acceptable: Webtrends, Mixpanel, Hotjar, Microsoft Clarity, Kissmetrics, Amplitude, SimilarWeb.)

6. Define “Dimensions” and “Metrics” in Google analytics. [SEE Oct/Nov 2023]

Dimensions are attributes of the data — qualitative descriptors such as city, device, browser, source/medium or page path; they form the rows of a report. **Metrics** are quantitative measurements — sessions, users, pageviews, bounce rate, revenue; they form the columns.

7. What is meant by campaign analysis in E-mail Marketing? [CIE-II 26 May 2026]

Evaluating the performance of e-mail campaigns using metrics such as open rate, click-through rate, conversion rate, bounce rate and unsubscribe rate, to determine effectiveness and improve future campaigns.

8. Define Click Through Rate (CTR) in E-mail Marketing. [CIE-II 26 May 2026]

CTR is the percentage of recipients who click on links in an e-mail compared to the total number of delivered e-mails.

9. List any four advantages of E-mail Marketing over traditional marketing methods. [CIE-II 26 May 2026]

Low cost; global reach; easy performance tracking; personalised communication.

10. Why is segmentation important in e-mail marketing campaigns? [SEE Jun/Jul 2025]

Segmentation divides the list by demographics, behaviour, engagement or lifecycle stage so each group receives relevant content. It raises open and click rates, reduces unsubscribes and spam complaints, protects deliverability and enables the personalisation that drives conversion.

11. List any two key components of a successful email marketing campaign. [SEE Oct/Nov 2023]

A permission-based, well-segmented opt-in list, and a compelling subject line with a single clear call to action. (Also acceptable: personalised relevant content; mobile-responsive design; measurable KPIs.)

12. After conducting an email marketing campaign for a travel agency, outline two specific metrics you would analyze to assess the campaign's performance. [CIE-II Quiz 24 Jul 2024]

Click-through rate, to judge whether the destinations and offers presented were relevant enough to earn a click; and **conversion rate** (bookings or enquiry-form completions per click), to judge whether the campaign produced business value rather than merely interest.

13. You are tasked with creating an effective email campaign to promote a summer sale for a fashion brand. Describe two strategies you would employ to increase open rates and click-through rates. [CIE-II Quiz 24 Jul 2024]

See §3.9.5 — a personalised, urgency-bearing, A/B-tested subject line with optimised send time to raise opens; and a single dominant benefit-led CTA above the fold with segmented product recommendations to raise clicks.

B. Ten-Mark and Eight-Mark Questions (Part B)

1. Differentiate between traditional marketing analysis and web analytics-based marketing analysis with suitable examples. [CIE-II 26 May 2026]

Use the comparison table in §3.1.2 — data collection, speed, accuracy, customer tracking, cost, measurement, sample, attribution and feedback loop — each with an example.

2. Explain the role of web analytics in digital marketing. How can businesses benefit from analysing website data? [CIE-II 07.05.2025]

See §3.3 — the eight roles and the seven benefits.

3. Develop a basic strategy to set up Google Analytics for a new e-commerce website. What key metrics should be tracked? [CIE-II 07.05.2025]

Setup strategy: (1) create the GA4 property and data stream; (2) deploy the tag through Google Tag Manager rather than hard-coding; (3) define the measurement plan — what business questions must the data answer; (4) configure enhanced e-commerce events (view_item, add_to_cart, begin_checkout, purchase); (5) mark purchase and lead events as conversions and assign values; (6) build the checkout funnel exploration; (7) apply UTM tagging conventions to every campaign; (8) link Google Ads and Search Console; (9) configure internal-traffic and bot filters; (10) set up audiences for remarketing; (11) build a Looker Studio dashboard; (12) validate in DebugView and real-time before trusting the data. **Key metrics:** sessions and users by channel; new vs returning; bounce/engagement rate; average session duration; product views, add-to-cart rate and cart-abandonment rate; checkout completion rate; conversion rate; average order value; revenue; return on ad spend; and cost per acquisition by channel.

4. How can businesses align Web Analytics KPIs with their organizational goals? Illustrate with examples. [CIE-I 16 Apr 2026]

See §3.3.3 — the five-step method with the goal-to-KPI mapping and a SMART example.

5. Discuss the concept of “Acquisition channels” in Google Analytics. How can business use this information to optimize their marketing efforts? [SEE Oct/Nov 2023, Q5a]

See §3.2.3 — define acquisition channels, list them with meaning and optimisation action, and explain the six ways businesses act on the data.

6. Explain the significance of A/B testing and conversion rate optimization in Web Analytics. How can these practices help improve website performance? [SEE Oct/Nov 2023, Q5b]

See §3.3.4 — definitions, significance, what to test, the six-step process and the tools.

7. List and explain the various reports that can be generated using google analytics. [SEE Oct/Nov 2023, Q6b]

See §3.2.4 — Real-Time, Audience/User, Acquisition, Behaviour/Engagement, Conversions/Monetisation, Attribution, and Custom reports/Explorations.

8. Describe the process of setting up and tracking goals in google analytics. How can businesses use goal tracking to measure website performance? [SEE Oct/Nov 2023, Q10b]

See §3.2.5 — the eight-step process, and the point that goals convert traffic reports into ROI reports.

9. Design a simple marketing plan for an e-learning platform using insights gathered from web analytics tools. [SEE Jun/Jul 2025, Q5a]

Insight gathering: GA4 shows that most traffic arrives from organic search on mobile, that the highest-engagement pages are free sample lessons, and that 70% of drop-off occurs on the payment page; Hotjar recordings show users hesitating at a nine-field sign-up form. **Plan:** (1) *Objective* — increase paid enrolments by 25% in one quarter. (2) *Audience* — segment into browsers, free-trial users and lapsed users. (3) *Channels* — SEO around “learn X online” long-tail queries, YouTube sample lessons, and a re-engagement e-mail sequence. (4) *Content* — free sample lesson as the lead magnet, since analytics identified it as the strongest engagement asset. (5) *Conversion fixes* — cut the sign-up form to four fields, add trust signals and a money-back guarantee at the payment step, and mobile-optimize checkout. (6) *E-mail* — trigger a nurture sequence on free-trial start and an abandoned-checkout reminder. (7) *Measurement* — track enrolment conversion rate, cost per enrolment, checkout completion rate and course-completion retention; review fortnightly.

10. Analyze a failed e-mail marketing campaign and identify areas where marketing research could have improved outcomes. [SEE Jun/Jul 2025, Q5b]

Diagnose against the funnel. *High bounce rate* → the list was purchased or stale; research into list source and hygiene would have prevented it. *Low open rate* → the subject line and sender name were untested; subject-line A/B research would have identified a winner. *Low CTR despite opens* → content was irrelevant to the segment; audience research and segmentation would have matched offer to interest. *Clicks but no conversions* → the landing page did not match the e-mail's promise; message-match testing and usability research would have caught it. *High unsubscribes and spam complaints* → expectations were never set at sign-up and frequency was too high; preference research would have fixed both. **Conclusion:** the failure was not a creative failure but a research failure — the campaign was designed from assumption rather than from audience data.

11. Describe the importance of audience segmentation and personalization in email marketing. Provide a step-by-step guide on how to segment an audience effectively and personalize email content based on segmentation criteria. [CIE-II 24 Jul 2024]

See §3.8.2 — the eight-step guide with the fashion-retailer example, preceded by the importance argument in §3.5.

12. Imagine you are a marketing manager for a startup selling organic skincare products. Develop a case study outlining the steps you would take to create and execute an effective e-mail campaign to launch a new product line. Include specific goals, target audience segmentation, content strategy, and metrics for success. [CIE-II 24 Jul 2024]

Goals: 3,000 pre-launch sign-ups; 25% open rate; 4% conversion on the launch send; ₹8 lakh revenue in the launch fortnight. **Segmentation:** existing customers by past category (cleansers, serums, sun care); engaged non-buyers; lapsed customers over 180 days; and new sign-ups from the pre-launch teaser. **Content strategy — a five-e-mail sequence:** (1) *teaser* to the full list, building anticipation with an ingredient story; (2) *educational* e-mail on the skin concern the range solves, establishing authority; (3) *launch announcement* with a hero product image and single CTA, personalised by segment; (4) *social proof* e-mail carrying testimonials and before-and-after images; (5) *urgency* e-mail for non-openers and cart abandoners with a 48-hour launch offer. Each is mobile-responsive, single-topic, with one dominant CTA. **Execution:** double opt-in capture, dynamic product blocks by segment, send-time optimisation, and A/B tests on subject lines for e-mails 3 and 5. **Metrics:** list growth rate, non-bounce rate, open rate, CTR, conversion rate, revenue per message, unsubscribe and spam-complaint rate — reviewed after each send so the sequence is optimised mid-flight.

13. Evaluate the challenges faced in maintaining successful E-mail Marketing campaigns and suggest suitable solutions to improve campaign performance. [CIE-II 26 May 2026]

See §3.9.4 — the six challenges with paired solutions, plus deliverability, list decay, rendering inconsistency and privacy changes.

14. Create a strategy to integrate Web Analytics and E-mail Marketing for improving customer engagement and business growth. [CIE-II 26 May 2026]

See §3.10.2 — the six-step strategy and the four benefits.

15. Analyse the effectiveness of an E-mail Marketing campaign using KPIs such as open rate, click-through rate, unsubscribe rate, and conversion rate. [CIE-II 26 May 2026]

See §3.9.3 — define each KPI, state what a high or low reading indicates, and give the corrective action. Anchor the answer in the six-stage measurement funnel (§3.9.2) so the KPIs are shown as a connected system rather than a list.

16. Design an E-mail Marketing plan for a newly launched online business targeting college students. [CIE-II 26 May 2026]

See §3.8.1 — the official seven-point scheme answer.

17. Evaluate the effectiveness of responsive email design in maintaining a competitive edge in digital marketing. [SEE Jun/Jul 2025, Q6a]

See §3.10.4 — the case for it, how it is achieved, and the critical view that it is now table stakes rather than a differentiator.

18. Critically evaluate the contribution of Google Tag Manager in optimizing marketing channels for global companies. [SEE Jun/Jul 2025, Q6b]

See the note in §3.2.6 — the six contributions and the four critical limitations.

19. Demonstrate how tools like Google Analytics and Hotjar can be used to develop insights into user behavior and improve marketing decisions. [SEE Jun/Jul 2025, Q7a]

Google Analytics gives the *what* — quantitative: which channels deliver traffic, which landing pages have high bounce, where users drop out of the checkout funnel, which segments convert, and what each channel costs per acquisition. **Hotjar gives the *why* — qualitative:** heatmaps show which elements attract attention and which are ignored; scroll maps show whether users ever reach the CTA; click maps expose “rage clicks” on non-clickable elements; session recordings show hesitation and confusion in real time; and on-page surveys capture the reason for abandonment in the user's own words. **Combined workflow:** GA identifies *that* the pricing page loses 60% of visitors → Hotjar recordings reveal users repeatedly clicking a non-clickable comparison table → the fix is to make it interactive → an A/B test

validates the change → GA confirms the improved funnel conversion. **Marketing decisions improved:** budget reallocation, landing page redesign priority, form simplification, content placement and mobile-specific fixes — each grounded in evidence rather than opinion.

HOW UNIT III IS EXAMINED

In the SEE, Unit III is **Questions 5 and 6 with internal choice** (16 marks in two 8-mark sub-divisions), plus 2–3 Part-A objective questions. CIE-II draws heavily on it. The highest-probability topics are: **the e-mail measurement funnel and KPI analysis, designing an e-mail marketing plan for a given scenario, segmentation and personalisation, Google Analytics reports, goals and acquisition channels, and traditional vs web-analytics-based analysis**. Note that almost every Unit III question is applied — you will be given a business and asked to build or diagnose something, so always answer with a named framework (the seven-node plan, the six-stage funnel, the eight-step goal setup) rather than general commentary.